

Algebraic Curves

Labix

April 17, 2026

Abstract

Contents

1	Algebraic Curves in Classical Algebraic Geometry	3
1.1	Basic Properties of Curves	3
1.2	The Smooth Projective Irreducible Models	4
1.3	The Theory of Divisors	5
1.4	The Riemann-Roch Theorem	7
2	Morphisms of Curves	9
2.1	The Degree of a Morphism	9
2.2	The Pullback Map of Divisors	10
2.3	The Riemann-Hurwitz Formula	10
3	Maps from Curves to Projective Space	14
3.1	Base Point Free and Very Ample Divisors	14
3.2	Classification of Regular Maps into Projective Space	15
4	Curves with Low Genus	16
4.1	Genus 0 Curves	16
4.2	Genus 1 Curves	17
4.3	Genus 2 Curve	17

1 Algebraic Curves in Classical Algebraic Geometry

1.1 Basic Properties of Curves

Definition 1.1.1 (Curves)

Let k be a field. Let X be a variety over k . We say that X is a curve if $\dim(X) = 1$.

Example 1.1.2

Let k be a field. Let $f \in k[x, y]$ be irreducible. Then

$$\operatorname{Spec} \left(\frac{k[x, y]}{(f)} \right)$$

is an irreducible curve over k .

Proposition 1.1.3

Let k be a field. Let X be a curve over k . Let $p \in X$ be a closed point. Then the following are equivalent.

- $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$ is a regular local ring.
- $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$ is a DVR.
- $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$ is normal.

Example 1.1.4

Consider the projective curve $C = \mathbb{V}(x^2 + y^2 - z^2) \subset \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^2$. Let $p = [p_0 : p_1 : p_2]$ be a point on the curve. Then $\mathcal{O}_{C,p}$ is a DVR.

Proof

If $p_2 \neq 0$, then $p \in U_2$. Under the affine chart (U_2, φ_2) , we find that $C_2 = \varphi_2(C \cap U_2) = \mathbb{V}(x^2 + y^2 - 1)$. The corresponding coordinate ring is given by $\frac{\mathbb{C}[x, y]}{(x^2 + y^2 - 1)}$. The formula for the local ring in the affine case gives

$$\mathcal{O}_{C,p} \cong \left(\frac{\mathbb{C}[x, y]}{(x^2 + y^2 - 1)} \right)_{m_{(p_0/p_2, p_1/p_2)}}$$

Recall that the unique maximal ideal of the local ring is given as the $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$ -module $m_p = \{f \in \mathbb{C}[C_2] \mid f(p_0/p_2, p_1/p_2) = 0\}$, which under the nullstellensatz is the maximal ideal corresponding to the point $(p_0/p_2, p_1/p_2)$ and is given by $m_p = (x - r, y - s)$ where $r = p_0/p_1$ and $s = p_0/p_2$. By Nakayama's lemma, since $x - r, y - s$ generate m_p we know that $x - r + m_p^2, y - s + m_p^2$ span the vector space m_p/m_p^2 over $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}/m_p$. I claim that they are linearly dependent. This means that I want to find $f + m_p^2$ and $g + m_p^2$ in $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}/m_p$ that are non-trivial, and that $(x - r)f + (y - s)g + m_p^2 = m_p^2$. This means that we want to find $f, g \in \mathcal{O}_{X,p} \setminus m_p$ such that $(x - r)f + (y - s)g \in m_p^2$. Choose $f = x + r$ and $g = y + s$ to get

$$(x - r)(x + r) + (y - s)(y + s) = x^2 - r^2 + y^2 - s^2 = 1 - 1 = 0$$

since (r, s) lie on the curve. Moreover, $x + r, y + s \notin m_p$ since evaluating at (r, s) at the functions are non-zero. This verifies that $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$ is a regular local ring of dimension 1, hence is a DVR. ■

Proposition 1.1.5

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be an irreducible curve over k . Then C is birational to a unique (up to isomorphism) smooth projective irreducible curve.

Proof

We know that C is birational to its normalization, which is a smooth curve. ■

Proposition 1.1.6

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be an irreducible curve over k . Then C is projective if

and only if C is proper.

Proposition 1.1.7

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be an irreducible curve over k . Suppose that C is birational to $\mathbb{P}^1$ (rational) and C is not isomorphic to $\mathbb{P}^1$. Then the following are true.

- C is isomorphic to an open subset of $\mathbb{A}_k^1$.
- C is an affine curve.
- $k[C]$ is a UFD,

1.2 The Smooth Projective Irreducible Models

Proposition 1.2.1

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Then there is an equivalence of categories between the following two categories.

- The category of smooth projective irreducible curves over k , together with dominant rational maps.
- Finitely generated field extensions of k of transcendence degree 1.

The equivalence is given by sending an irreducible curve C to its function field $k(C)$.

Proposition 1.2.2

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be a smooth curve over k . Let $X \subseteq \mathbb{P}^n$ be a projective variety. Let $\phi : U \subseteq C \rightarrow X$ be a rational map. Then there exists a regular map

$$\bar{\phi} : C \rightarrow X$$

such that $\bar{\phi}|_U = \phi|_U$ for some dense subset $U \subseteq C$.

Proof

Notice that it suffices to extend ϕ to a map $\bar{\phi} : C \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^n$ because in this case we have

$$\bar{\phi}(C) = \bar{\phi}(\bar{U}) \subseteq \overline{\bar{\phi}(U)} = \overline{\phi(U)} \subseteq \bar{X} = X$$

anyway. Since C is a curve and $U \subseteq C$ is open, $C \setminus U = \{p_1, \dots, p_n\}$ consists of finitely many points. We induct on $p_1, \dots, p_n$ by starting out with the map ϕ .

Assume that we are given the map $\bar{\phi}$ that is well defined on $U \cup \{p_1, \dots, p_k\}$. Since C is smooth, $\mathcal{O}_{C, p_{k+1}}$ is a DVR. Let $\pi \in \mathcal{O}_{C, p_{k+1}}$ be a uniformizer. Suppose that $\bar{\phi}$ is given in coordinates as $[f_0 : \dots : f_n]$ for $f_0, \dots, f_n \in K(C)$. Let $a = \min\{\text{val}_{p_{k+1}}(f_i) \mid 1 \leq i \leq n\}$. Then since our coordinates are projective, we have that

$$\bar{\phi}(x) = [f_0(x) : \dots : f_n(x)] = [\pi^{-a}(x)f_0(x) : \dots : \pi^{-a}(x)f_n(x)]$$

for all $x \in U$. Moreover, for each i , we have $\text{val}_{p_{k+1}}(\pi^{-a}f_i) \geq 0$ and so our new map is regular on p_{k+1} . By induction we are done. ■

Example 1.2.3

Let k be a field. Consider the rational map $\phi : \mathbb{P}_k^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_k^2$ defined by

$$\phi([s : t]) = \left[\frac{s+t}{s} : \frac{st+t^2}{(s-t)^2} : \frac{s^2-t^2}{t^2} \right]$$

This map can be extended to the morphism of varieties

$$\bar{\phi}([s : t]) = [t^2(s-t)^2(s+t) : t^3s(s+t) : (s-t)^2s(s^2-t^2)]$$

Proof

Notice that the degrees of each component is constant. Moreover, they simultaneously vanish if and only if $s = t = 0$. Finally, by dividing each coordinate with $\frac{s(s-t)^2 t^2}{s+t}$ we obtain the original rational map, and hence this morphism of varieties agree with the rational map. ■

Note that the extended map is obtained by clearing denominators, because by clearing denominators we are multiplying each coordinate with the same map, and because the coordinates are projective this does not change the projective coordinates.

Proposition 1.2.4

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let X, Y be smooth irreducible projective curves over k . Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a rational map. If ϕ is birational, then ϕ is an isomorphism of varieties.

Proof By 1.2.1, we can extend ϕ to a regular map $\bar{\phi} : X \rightarrow Y$. Similarly we can extend ϕ^{-1} to a regular map $\bar{\phi}^{-1} : Y \rightarrow X$. Then $\bar{\phi}^{-1} \circ \bar{\phi} : X \rightarrow X$ is the identity map since $\phi^{-1} \circ \phi$ agrees with id_X on a dense open subset of X . ■

1.3 The Theory of Divisors

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be a smooth projective irreducible curve. Then we know that there are isomorphisms

$$\text{Div}(C) \cong \text{CDiv}(C) \quad \text{and} \quad \text{Cl}(C) \cong \text{CCL}(C)$$

Recall that the canonical divisor is a divisor K_C such that

$$\mathcal{L}(K_C) = \Omega_{C/\mathbb{C}}^1$$

We may compute the divisor in the following way. Recall that given a line bundle $\mathcal{L}$, to recover the divisor, we take the tensor product $\mathcal{L} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{Q}_X$. Locally at a chart we have $\mathcal{L}(U) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X(U)} \mathcal{Q}_X(U) \cong \mathcal{Q}_X(U)$. Now pick a global section s of the tensor product. Locally at each U_i , it corresponds to a local section $f_i \in \mathcal{Q}_X(U)$. Then $\{(U_i, f_i) \mid i \in I\}$ is precisely the Cartier data of the canonical divisor.

Now since $\Gamma(X, \Omega_{C/\mathbb{C}}^1 \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{Q}_X) = \Omega_{\text{C}(C)/\mathbb{C}}^1$, a choice of canonical divisor just corresponds to a non-zero element of $\Omega_{\text{C}(C)/\mathbb{C}}^1$. Let us look at an example.

Example 1.3.1

Let $C = \mathbb{V}^H(x^2 + y^2 - z^2) \subseteq \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^2$. Let $\omega = \frac{x+z}{z} d\left(\frac{x}{z}\right) \in \Omega_{\text{C}(C)/\mathbb{C}}^1$ be a one-form. Then we have

$$K_C = [1 : 0 : 1] + 3[-1 : 0 : 1] - 3[i : 1 : 0] - 3[-i : 1 : 0]$$

Proof

We compute the coefficients of each point on each affine chart. On the chart U_2 , ω is given by $x + 1d(x)$. For any point $p = (p_0, p_1) \in C \cap U_2 = \mathbb{V}(x^2 + y^2 - 1)$, I claim that $x - p_0$ is a uniformizer of $\mathcal{O}_{C \cap U_2, p}$ if and only if $p_1 \neq 0$. Indeed, we know that $m_p \mathcal{O}_{C \cap U_2, p}$ is generated by $x - p_0$ and $y - p_1$. Hence $[x - p_0]$ and $[y - p_1]$ spans m_p/m_p^2 . If $p_1 \neq 0$, then $y + p_1 \in \mathcal{O}_{C \cap U_2, p}$ and so

$$y - p_1 = \frac{y^2 - p_1^2}{y + p_1} = \frac{1 - x^2 - 1 + p_0^2}{y + p_1} = -\frac{x + p_0}{y + p_1}(x - p_0)$$

Hence $[x - p_0]$ generates m_p/m_p^2 and so $x - p_0$ generates m_p by a corollary of Nakayama's lemma. Conversely, if $p_1 = 0$, then we have $p_0 = \pm 1$ and $x \mp 1 \in \mathcal{O}_{C \cap U_2, p}$. Then we have

$$x \pm 1 = \frac{x^2 - 1}{x \mp 1} = \frac{1}{x \mp 1} y^2$$

so that $[x \pm 1]$ is the 0 vector in m_p/m_p^2 . Hence $x \pm 1$ cannot generate $m_p \mathcal{O}_{C \cap U_2, p}$. So there are now two cases:

Case 1: $p_1 \neq 0$.

Then $x - p_0$ is a uniformizer for $\mathcal{O}_{C \cap U_2, p}$ and $d(x - p_0) = d(x)$. Then we have $\text{val}_p(\omega) = \text{val}_p(x + 1)$ and this is non-zero if and only if $p_0 = -1$, but since $p_1 \neq 0$, no points in this case satisfy the criteria.

Case 2: $p_1 = 0$.

Then y is a uniformizer. From $x^2 + y^2 - 1 = 0$ in $\mathbb{C}[C]$, we infer that $d(x^2 + y^2 - 1) = 0$ in Ω_C^1 and hence $\Omega_{\mathbb{C}(C)/\mathbb{C}}^1$ since the module of Kahler differential commutes with quotients and localizations. The condition then becomes $2xdx + 2ydy = 0$, or that $dx = -\frac{y}{x}dy$. Hence ω in this open chart can be written as $x + 1dx = -\frac{(x+1)y}{x}dy$. Hence

$$\text{val}_p(\omega) = \text{val}_p\left(-\frac{(x+1)y}{x}\right)$$

If $p_1 = 1$, then $x + 1$ is a unit in $\mathcal{O}_{C \cap U_2, p}$, hence $\text{val}_p\left(-\frac{x+1}{x}y\right) = 1$. Hence the coefficient of $[1 : 0 : 1]$ is 1. If $p_1 = -1$, then $x - 1$ is a unit in $\mathcal{O}_{C \cap U_2, p}$, so we have

$$\text{val}_p\left(-\frac{x+1}{x}y\right) = \text{val}_p\left(-\frac{x^2-1}{x(x-1)}y\right) = \text{val}_p\left(-\frac{-y^2}{x(x-1)}y\right) = \text{val}_p\left(\frac{1}{x(x-1)}y^3\right) = 3$$

Hence the coefficient of $[-1 : 0 : 1]$ is 3.

Notice that $C \setminus U_2 = \mathbb{V}^H(x^2 + y^2) \cap \mathbb{V}^H(z) = \{[i : 1 : 0], [-i : 1 : 0]\}$. It suffices to consider the coefficients of this two points, and they both lie in U_1 . Now $C \cap U_1 = \mathbb{V}(x^2 + 1 - z^2)$. The 1-form ω does not change under the chart U_1 . Similarly as the above chart, the relation $x^2 + 1 - z^2 = 0$ gives the relation $2xdx = 2zdz$ in the module of Kaehler differentials. Now we have

$$\frac{x+z}{z}d\left(\frac{x}{z}\right) = \frac{x+z}{z} \frac{zd(x) - xd(z)}{z^2}$$

In the local rings of both of our points, the function x is invertible, so we have $dx = \frac{z}{x}dz$ and so

$$\frac{x+z}{z} \frac{zd(x) - xd(z)}{z^2} = \frac{x+z}{z} \frac{z(z/x d(z)) - xd(z)}{z^2} = \frac{xz^2 - x^3 + z^3 - xz^2}{xz^3} d(z) = \frac{(z-x)(x+z)^2}{xz^3} d(z)$$

Moreover, z is a uniformizer of both local rings because at least one of $x \mp i$ is invertible so that $x \pm i = \frac{1}{x \mp i} z^2$ and so the generator $x \pm i$ of the maximal ideal $m_p \mathcal{O}_{C \cap U_1, p}$ is redundant. Hence we have that

$$\text{val}_p(\omega) = \text{val}_p\left(\frac{(z-x)(x+z)^2}{xz^3}\right) = \text{val}_p((z-x)(x+z)^2) - \text{val}_p((xz^3)^2)$$

The first term is non-zero if and only if $(z-x)(x+z)^2 \in m_p \mathcal{O}_{C \cap U_1, p}$ if and only if $p_0 \pm p_2$, both of our points do not satisfy this. The second term is non-zero if and only if $xz^3 \in m_p \mathcal{O}_{C \cap U_1, p}$ if and only if $p_0 = 0$ or $p_2 = 0$. Hence we conclude that the coefficient of both $[i : 1 : 0]$ and $[-i : 1 : 0]$ is -3 .

Putting all the non-zero coefficients together with the corresponding points, we deduce that

$$K_C = [1 : 0 : 1] + 3[-1 : 0 : 1] - 3[i : 1 : 0] - 3[-i : 1 : 0]$$

■

1.4 The Riemann-Roch Theorem

Definition 1.4.1 (Dimension of Global Sections)

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Let D be a divisor on C . Define

$$l(D) = \dim_k(\Gamma(X, \mathcal{L}(D)))$$

Proposition 1.4.2

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let X be a smooth irreducible projective curve over k . Let $D \in \text{Div}(X)$ be a divisor. Then the following are true.

- $l(D)$ is a finite dimensional vector space over k .
- If $\deg(D) < 0$, then we have

$$l(D) = 0$$

- If $\deg(D) = 0$, then we have

$$l(D) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } D \not\sim 0 \\ 1 & \text{if } D \sim 0 \end{cases}$$

Proof

Suppose that $\deg(D) < 0$. For any $f \in k(X)$, we have $\deg(D + \text{div}(f)) = \deg(D) + \deg(\text{div}(f)) = \deg(D) < 0$. Hence $D + \text{div}(f)$ can never be effective.

Now suppose that $\deg(D) = 0$. For any $f \in k(X)$, we have $\deg(D + \text{div}(f)) = \deg(D) + \deg(\text{div}(f)) = 0$ and so $f \in \mathcal{L}(D)$ if and only if $D + \text{div}(f)$ is effective if and only if $D + \text{div}(f) = 0$ if and only if $\text{div}(1/f) = D$. If $D \not\sim 0$ then $\text{div}(1/f) = D$ cannot happen by definition. Hence $\mathcal{L}(D) = \{0\}$ in this case. If $D \sim 0$, then there exists $g \in k(X)$ such that $D = \text{div}(g)$. Then $\text{div}(1/f) = \text{div}(g)$ if and only if $\text{div}(fg) = 0$ if and only if fg is regular and does not vanish on X . But since X is projective, the only regular and non-vanishing rational function are the constants. Hence $fg = c$ implies $f = c/g$ for some $c \in k$. Hence $\mathcal{L}(D) = k\langle 1/g \rangle$ and so the dimension in this case is 1. ■

Lemma 1.4.3

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let X be a smooth irreducible projective curve over k . Let $D \in \text{Div}(X)$ be a divisor. Let $p \in X$. Then we have

$$0 \leq l(D) - l(D - p) \leq 1$$

Proof

We have $\mathcal{L}(D - p) \subseteq \mathcal{L}(D)$ since for $f \in \mathcal{L}(D - p)$, we have that $D - p + \text{div}(f)$ is effective and so $D + \text{div}(f)$ must be effective. Let n_p be the coefficient of p in D . Let π be a uniformizer of $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$. Since $D + \text{div}(f)$ is effective, we must have $\text{val}_p(f\pi^{n_p}) \geq 0$. Consider the map $\phi : \mathcal{L}(D) \rightarrow k$ defined by $\phi(f) = (f\pi^{n_p})(p)$. Now we have that $f \in \ker(\phi)$ if and only if $\text{val}_p(f\pi^{n_p}) > 0$ if and only if $\text{val}_p(f) + n_p - 1 \geq 0$ if and only if $f \in \mathcal{L}(D - p)$. Hence $\ker(\phi) = \mathcal{L}(D - p)$. By rank nullity theorem, we have $\dim_k(\mathcal{L}(D)) = \dim_k(\mathcal{L}(D - p)) + \dim(\text{im}(\phi))$. Since $\dim(\text{im}(\phi))$ is either 0 or 1, we must have either $\dim_k(\mathcal{L}(D)) = \dim_k(\mathcal{L}(D - p))$ or $\dim_k(\mathcal{L}(D)) = \dim_k(\mathcal{L}(D - p)) + 1$. ■

Proposition 1.4.4

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let X be a smooth irreducible projective curve over k . Let $D \in \text{Div}(X)$ be a divisor. If $\deg(D) \geq 0$, then we have

$$l(D) \leq \deg(D) + 1$$

Proof

The results follow by induction and by applying the above lemma. ■

Theorem 1.4.5 (The Riemann-Roch Theorem)

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $D \in \text{Div}(C)$ be a divisor on C . Then we have

$$l(D) - l(K_C - D) = \deg(D) + 1 - p_g(C)$$

Proposition 1.4.6

Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $D \in \text{Div}(C)$ be a divisor on C . Then

$$\deg(D) + 1 - p_g(C) \leq \dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(D)) \leq \deg(D) + 1$$

Proof

The upper bound is given in 2.2.5. The lower bound is given since $\dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(K_C - D)) \geq 0$ using the Riemann-Roch theorem. ■

Proposition 1.4.7

Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Then we have

$$\deg(K_C) = 2p_g(C) - 2$$

Proof

Taking $D = K_C$, the Riemann-Roch theorem gives

$$\deg(K_C) = 2p_g(C) - \dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(0)) - 1$$

Also we have that

$$\mathcal{L}(0) = \{f \in \mathbb{C}(C) \mid \text{div}(f) \text{ is effective}\} = \mathcal{O}_C(C)$$

Hence $\dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(0)) = \dim(\mathcal{O}_C(C)) = 1$. ■

Lemma 1.4.8

Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve over $\mathbb{C}$. If $D \in \text{Div}(C)$ is a divisor such that $\deg(D) > 2g - 2$, then the following are true.

- $l(K_C - D) = 0$
- $l(D) = \deg(D) + 1 - g$

Proof

If $\deg(D) > 2g - 2$, then we have that $2g - 2 < \deg(D) = \deg(K_C) - \deg(K_C - D) = 2g - 2 - \deg(K_C - D)$. Hence $\deg(K_C - D) < 0$. Then by 2.2.4 we have that $\dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(K_C - D)) = 0$. The second item follows from the Riemann-Roch theorem. ■

2 Morphisms of Curves

2.1 The Degree of a Morphism

Proposition 2.1.1

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let X, Y be smooth irreducible projective curves over k . Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a regular map. Then exactly one of the following holds.

- ϕ is constant.
- $\phi(X) = Y$ and ϕ is a finite morphism.

Proof If ϕ is non-constant, then $\phi(X)$ is closed and connected and so $\phi(X) = Y$. In particular, ϕ is a dominant rational map and induces a k -algebra homomorphism $k(Y) \rightarrow k(X)$. Since $k(X)$ and $k(Y)$ both have transcendence degree 1, $k(X)$ is an algebraic extension of $k(Y)$.

Let $W \subseteq Y$ be an open affine subset. Let $\overline{k[W]}$ be the integral closure of $k[W]$ in $k(X)$. Then $\overline{k[W]}$ is a finitely generated $k[W]$ -module and hence corresponds to an irreducible affine curve V . I claim that $k(X) = k(V) = \text{Frac}(\overline{k[W]})$. We already know that $k[V] \subseteq k(X)$. Now let $f/g \in k(X)$. Since $k(X)$ is algebraic over $k(Y)$, there exists $h \in k(Y)[t]$ such that $h(f/g) = 0$. Clearing denominators, there exists $b_0, \dots, b_n \in k[W]$ such that

$$b_n(f/g)^n + b_{n-1}(f/g)^{n-1} + \dots + b_1(f/g) + b_0 = 0$$

Then we have

$$(b_n f/g)^n + b_{n-1}(b_n f/g)^{n-1} + b_{n-2}b_{n-1}(b_n f/g)^{n-2} + \dots + b_1 b_{n-1}^{n-2}(b_n f/g) + b_0 b_{n-1} = 0$$

Hence $b_n f/g$ is integral over $k[W]$. Hence $b_n f/g \in \overline{k[W]}$ and so $f/g \in \text{Frac}(\overline{k[W]})$.

The map $k[W] \rightarrow k[V]$ is induced by $\phi^* : k(Y) \rightarrow k(X)$. Hence the associated map $V \rightarrow W$ is also induced by ϕ . Thus V is an affine open subset of X . Hence $V \subseteq \phi^{-1}(W)$. Now I claim that $V = \phi^{-1}(W)$. Consider the following commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} k[\phi^{-1}(W)] & \xrightarrow{\text{incl.}^*} & k[V] \\ & \swarrow \phi^* \quad \searrow \phi^* & \\ & k[W] & \end{array}$$

By definition, $k[V]$ is a subring of $k(X)$. Hence we can take integral closure of all three rings in $k(X)$ to obtain the diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \overline{k[\phi^{-1}(W)]} & \xrightarrow{\text{incl.}^*} & k[V] \\ & \swarrow \phi^* \quad \searrow \text{id}_{k[V]} & \\ & k[V] & \end{array}$$

where the lower right arrow is the identity because $k[V] = \overline{k[W]}$ and the map $V \rightarrow W$ is induced by the inclusion map $k[W] \hookrightarrow \overline{k[W]}$. If $k[\phi^{-1}(W)]$ is integrally closed, then the above diagram induces an inverse map to the inclusion $V \hookrightarrow \phi^{-1}(W)$ so that $V = \phi^{-1}(W)$. ????

Since $k[V] = \overline{k[W]}$ is the integral closure of $k[W]$ in $k(X)$, $\overline{k[W]}$ is a finitely generated $k[W]$ -module. Hence $k[V] = k[\phi^{-1}(W)]$ is a finitely generated $k[W]$ -module. Hence ϕ is a finite morphism. ■

Definition 2.1.2 (Degree of a Morphism of Curves)

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let X, Y be smooth projective irreducible curves over k . Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-constant morphism. Define the degree of ϕ to be

$$\deg(\phi) = [k(X) : \phi^*k(Y)]$$

2.2 The Pullback Map of Divisors

Definition 2.2.1 (Pullback Map of Divisors)

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve. Let X be a smooth irreducible projective variety. Let $\phi : C \rightarrow X$ be a regular map. Define the induced pullback map $\phi^* : \text{Div}(X) \rightarrow \text{Div}(C)$ on generators by

$$\phi^*(H) = \sum_{p \in C} \text{val}_p(\phi^*(g)) \cdot p$$

where g is a generator of $\mathbb{I}(H)\mathcal{O}_{Y,\phi(p)}$.

When X is also a curve, we have

$$\phi^*(q) = \sum_{p \in \phi^{-1}(q)} e_\phi(p) \cdot p = \sum_{p \in \phi^{-1}(q)} \text{val}_p(\phi^*(\pi)) \cdot p$$

where π is the uniformizer of $\mathcal{O}_{Y,q}$.

Proposition 2.2.2 Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let X, Y be smooth irreducible projective curves over k . Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-constant regular map. Then we have

$$\deg(\phi^*(D)) = \deg(\phi) \deg(D)$$

for any $D \in \text{Div}(Y)$.

Proposition 2.2.3 Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let X, Y be smooth irreducible projective curves over k . Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-constant regular map. Then $\phi(\text{Prin}(Y)) \subseteq \text{Prin}(X)$.

Proposition 2.2.4 Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be an irreducible smooth curve over k . Then we have

$$\text{Prin}(C) \leq \ker(\deg)$$

Definition 2.2.5 (Induced Map of Divisor Class Groups) Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let X, Y be smooth irreducible projective curves over k . Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-constant regular map. Define the induced map of divisor class groups $\phi^* : \text{Cl}(Y) \rightarrow \text{Cl}(X)$ by

$$\phi^*([D]) = [\phi^*(D)]$$

2.3 The Riemann-Hurwitz Formula

Definition 2.3.1 (Ramification Index)

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let X, Y be smooth irreducible projective curves over k . Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-constant regular map. Let $p \in X$. Define the ramification index of ϕ at p to be

$$e_\phi(p) = v_p(\phi^*(\pi))$$

where π is a uniformizer of $\mathcal{O}_{Y,\phi(p)}$.

Example 2.3.2

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let $X = \mathbb{V}^H(x^2 + y^2 - z^2) \subseteq \mathbb{P}_k^2$. Let $\phi : X \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_k^1$ be the map defined by $[x : y : z] \mapsto [x : z]$. Then we have

$$e_\phi([1 : 0 : 1]) = 2$$

Proof

Taking local charts U_2 on the domain and U_1 on the codomain, the restriction of ϕ to the affine

piece is the map $X \cap U_2 = \mathbb{V}(x^2 + y^2 - 1) \rightarrow \mathbb{A}_k^1$ defined by $(x, y) \mapsto x$. The induced map local rings is the k -algebra homomorphism $\phi^* : k[x] \rightarrow \frac{k[x, y]}{(x^2 + y^2 - 1)}$ given by $x \mapsto x$. Under the affine chart, the point $[1 : 0 : 1]$ has affine coordinates $(1, 0)$ in U_2 . A uniformizer of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{A}_k^1, 1}$ is $x - 1$ and we have $\phi^*(x - 1) = x - 1$. Thus we have

$$e_\phi([1 : 0 : 1]) = e_{\phi|_{U_2}}(1, 0) = \text{val}_{(1,0)}(x - 1)$$

Now we want to work out a uniformizer for $\mathcal{O}_{X \cap U_2, (1,0)}$. The maximal ideal $m_{(1,0)} \mathcal{O}_{X \cap U_2, (1,0)}$ is generated by $x - 1$ and y . Now $x + 1 \notin m_p$ and so $\frac{1}{x+1} \in \mathcal{O}_{X \cap U_2, (1,0)}$. Then we have

$$x - 1 = \frac{x^2 - 1}{x + 1} = \frac{-y^2}{x + 1}$$

Hence $x + 1$ is a redundant generator of $m_{(1,0)} \mathcal{O}_{X \cap U_2, (1,0)}$. Hence $m_{(1,0)} \mathcal{O}_{X \cap U_2, (1,0)} = (y) \mathcal{O}_{X \cap U_2, (1,0)}$ and y is a uniformizer of the DVR. From the same calculations, we deduce that

$$e_\phi([1 : 0 : 1]) = \text{val}_{(1,0)}(x - 1) = \text{val}_{(1,0)}\left(\frac{-1}{x + 1} y^2\right) = 2$$

■

Lemma 2.3.3

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let X, Y be smooth irreducible projective curves over k . Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-constant regular map. Let $p \in X$. Then

$$e_\phi(p) = \dim_k \left(\frac{\mathcal{O}_{X,p}}{(\phi^*(\pi))} \right)$$

where π is a uniformizer of $\mathcal{O}_{Y, \phi(p)}$.

Proof

If $e_\phi(p) = 0$, then $\phi^*(\pi)$ is a unit and so $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}/(\phi^*(\pi)) = \{0\}$. Hence $\dim_k(\mathcal{O}_{X,p}/(\phi^*(\pi))) = 0$. Now suppose that $e_\phi(p) = n \neq 0$. Let t be a uniformizer of $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$. Then we have

$$\frac{\mathcal{O}_{X,p}}{(\phi^*(\pi))} = \frac{\mathcal{O}_{X,p}}{(t^n)}$$

is a $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}/(t) = \mathcal{O}_{X,p}/m_p \cong k$ vector space. Since $\mathcal{O}_{X,p}$ is a regular local ring of dimension 1, we have that

$$\dim_{R/m} \left(\frac{\mathcal{O}_{X,p}}{(t^n)} \right) = \binom{n-1+1}{n-1} = n$$

from Commutative Algebra 2. ■

Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-constant regular map between smooth irreducible and projective curves. Since ϕ is finite, the notion of degree makes sense. Recall that the degree is defined to be

$$\deg(\phi) = \dim_{K(Y)} K(X)$$

Proposition 2.3.4

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let X, Y be smooth irreducible projective curves over k . Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-constant regular map. Let $q \in Y$. Then we have

$$\sum_{p \in \phi^{-1}(q)} e_\phi(p) = \deg(\phi)$$

Proof

Without loss of generality take X and Y to be affine. Since ϕ is non-constant, it is dominant and so that induced map $\phi^* : k[Y] \rightarrow k[X]$ is injective. Let $S = k[Y] \setminus m_q$. Localize both $k[Y]$ and

$k[X]$ as $k[Y]$ -modules to obtain a map $\mathcal{O}_{Y,q} \rightarrow S^{-1}k[X]$. Since every non-constant regular map between curves is finite, we know that $k[X]$ is finitely generated as a $k[Y]$ -module and hence $S^{-1}k[X]$ is finitely generated as a $\mathcal{O}_{Y,q}$ -module.

I claim that $S^{-1}k[X]$ is a torsion free $\mathcal{O}_{Y,q}$ -module. Indeed, if $f/g \in S^{-1}k[X]$ and $h/k \in \mathcal{O}_{Y,q}$ are non-zero and that $fh/gk = 0$, then $fh/gk = 0$ in $k(X)$ is a contradiction since $k(X)$ is a field. Now since $\mathcal{O}_{Y,q}$ is a DVR, it is also a PID. Hence by the structure theorem for finitely generated modules over a PID, we have that $S^{-1}k[X] \cong \mathcal{O}_{Y,q}^r$ for some $r \in \mathbb{N}$. Taking fraction fields show that $k(X)$ is an r dimensional vector space over $k(Y)$. Then by definition we have $r = \deg(\phi)$.

Let π be a uniformizer for $\mathcal{O}_{Y,q}$. Then $\frac{S^{-1}k[X]}{\phi^*(\pi)}$ is an $\frac{\mathcal{O}_{Y,q}}{(\pi)} \cong k$ -module. Then $S^{-1}k[X] \cong \mathcal{O}_{Y,q}^{\deg(\phi)}$ implies that

$$\frac{S^{-1}k[X]}{\phi^*(\pi)} \cong \left(\frac{\mathcal{O}_{Y,q}}{(\pi)} \right)^{\deg(\phi)}$$

Also, by the correspondence of ideals of localization, we know that the maximal ideals of $S^{-1}k[X]$ as a ring is given by m_p for $p \in \phi^{-1}(q)$. Since ϕ is a finite morphism, there are finitely many such maximal ideals. I claim that

$$(\phi^*(\pi))k(X) = \bigcap_{p \in \phi^{-1}(q)} (\phi^*(\pi)\mathcal{O}_{X,p} \cap S^{-1}k[X]) \subseteq k(X)$$

Clearly the left is contained in the right. Now let f be an element in the right. Then $f/(\phi^*(\pi)) \in \mathcal{O}_{X,p}$. Since any integral domain is the intersection of its localization at maximal ideals, we conclude that $f/(\phi^*(\pi)) \in S^{-1}k[X]$. Hence $f \in (\phi^*(\pi))$.

Now the ideals $(\phi^*(\pi)\mathcal{O}_{X,p} \cap S^{-1}k[X])$ for varying p are coprime. By the CRT, we have

$$\frac{S^{-1}k[X]}{(\phi^*(\pi))} \cong \prod_{p \in \phi^{-1}(q)} \frac{S^{-1}k[X]}{\phi^*(\pi)\mathcal{O}_{X,p} \cap S^{-1}k[X]} \cong \prod_{p \in \phi^{-1}(q)} \frac{\mathcal{O}_{X,p}}{\phi^*(\pi)\mathcal{O}_{X,p}}$$

where the second isomorphism comes from the fact that localization at $S^{-1}k[X] \setminus m_p$ commutes with quotients and $S^{-1}k[X] \setminus m_p$ consists of units in $S^{-1}k[X]$. Then we have

$$\deg(\phi) = \dim \left(\frac{S^{-1}k[X]}{(\phi^*(\pi))} \right) = \sum_{p \in \phi^{-1}(q)} \dim \left(\frac{\mathcal{O}_{X,p}}{\phi^*(\pi)\mathcal{O}_{X,p}} \right) = \sum_{p \in \phi^{-1}(q)} e_\phi(p)$$

■

Definition 2.3.5 (Ramification Divisor)

Let X, Y be smooth irreducible projective curves over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-constant regular map. Define the ramification divisor to be

$$R_\phi = \sum_{p \in X} (e_\phi(p) - 1) \in \text{Div}(X)$$

Proposition 2.3.6

Let X, Y be smooth irreducible projective curves over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-constant regular map. Then we have

$$K_X = \phi^*(K_Y) + R_\phi$$

Theorem 2.3.7 (Riemann-Hurwitz Formula)

Let X, Y be smooth irreducible projective curves over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $\phi : X \rightarrow Y$ be a non-constant regular map. Then we have

$$2p_g(X) - 2 = \deg(\phi)(2p_g(Y) - 2) + \deg(R_\phi)$$

Proposition 2.3.8

Let $C \subseteq \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^2$ be a smooth curve of degree d . Then we have

$$p_g(C) = \frac{(d-1)(d-2)}{2}$$

3 Maps from Curves to Projective Space

3.1 Base Point Free and Very Ample Divisors

Let C be a smooth projective irreducible curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Let D be a divisor on C . Recall the associated rational map $F_D : C \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(\Gamma(X, \mathcal{L}(D))^*)$ given by

$$p \mapsto \left(\begin{array}{c} \phi_p : \mathcal{L}(D) \rightarrow \mathbb{C} \\ f \mapsto (f \cdot \pi^{n_p})(p) \end{array} \right)$$

where π is a uniformizer of $\mathcal{O}_{C,p}$ and n_p is the coefficient of p in D . It is a genuine morphism if and only if D is base point free.

Proposition 3.1.1

Let C be a smooth projective irreducible curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $D \in \text{Div}(C)$ be a divisor. Then D is basepoint free if and only if

$$l(D - p) = l(D) - 1$$

for all $p \in C$.

Proof

Let n_p be the coefficient of a point $p \in C$ in D . Suppose that D is basepoint free. Then there exists $f \in \mathcal{L}(D)$ such that $\text{val}_p(f) + n_p = 0$ and so $\text{val}_p(f) + n_p - 1 < 0$. Hence $D - p + \text{div}(f)$ is not effective and so $f \notin \mathcal{L}(D - p)$. Hence $\mathcal{L}(D - p) \subset \mathcal{L}(D)$ is a strict subset. Then by 2.2.5 we are done.

Conversely, suppose that the condition on dimensions are satisfied. Since $\mathcal{L}(D - p) \subset \mathcal{L}(D)$ is a strict subset, there exists $f \in \mathcal{L}(D)$ such that $D - p + \text{div}(f)$ is not effective but $D + \text{div}(f)$ is effective. This means that $\text{val}_p(f\pi^{n_p-1}) < 0$ and $\text{val}_p(f\pi^{n_p}) \geq 0$. Hence $\text{val}_p(f\pi^{n_p}) = 0$. Since this is true for all p , we conclude that D is base point free. ■

Corollary 3.1.2

Let C be a smooth projective irreducible curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $D \in \text{Div}(C)$ be a divisor. If $\deg(D) \geq 2g$ then D is base point free.

Proof If $\deg(D) \geq 2g$, then for any $p \in C$, we have $\deg(D - p) \geq 2g - 1$. Hence by a corollary of the Riemann-Roch theorem, we have

$$\dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(D - p)) = \deg(D - p) + 1 - g = \deg(D) + 1 - g - 1 = \dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(D)) - 1$$

By the above proposition, D is base point free. ■

Also recall that the associated map $F_D : C \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(\Gamma(X, \mathcal{L}(D))^*)$ is a closed embedding if and only if $\mathcal{L}(D)$ is very ample.

Proposition 3.1.3

Let C be a smooth projective irreducible curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $D \in \text{Div}(C)$. Then D is very ample if and only if for all $p, q \in C$, we have

$$l(D - p - q) = l(D) - 2$$

Corollary 3.1.4

Let C be a smooth projective irreducible curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $D \in \text{Div}(C)$. If $\deg(D) \geq 2g + 1$ then D is very ample.

Proposition 3.1.5

Let C be a smooth projective irreducible curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $D \in \text{Div}(C)$ be a base point free divisor. Then there is a one-to-one correspondence

$$\{H \subseteq \mathbb{P}(\mathcal{L}(D)^*) \mid H \text{ is a hyperplane}\} \xleftrightarrow{1:1} \{E \in \text{Div}(C) \mid E \text{ is effective and } E \sim D\}$$

The map is given by $H \mapsto (F_D)^*(H)$ where F_D^* is the map $\text{Div}(\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{L}(D)^*)) \rightarrow \text{Div}(C)$.

Proof

We know from Algebraic Geometry 1 that there is a bijection between points in $\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{L}(D))$ and hyperplanes in $\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{L}(D)^*)$. Thus combining with the above prp gives a bijection between our two sets. We want to check that this composition of bijection is indeed the map $H \mapsto (F_D)^*(H)$.

Choose a basis $e_0, \dots, e_n$ for $\mathcal{L}(D)$ and hence a dual basis $\alpha_0, \dots, \alpha_n$ for $\mathcal{L}(D)^*$. Let H be a hyperplane in $\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{L}(D)^*)$. Then $H = \mathbb{V}^H(A_0x_0 + \dots + A_nx_n)$ for $x_0, \dots, x_n$ the coordinates on $\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{L}(D)^*)$ and $A_0, \dots, A_n \in \mathbb{C}$. Then the duality between points and hyperplanes gives the point $[A_0 : \dots : A_n] \in \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^n$. Under the bijection $\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^n \cong \mathbb{P}(\mathcal{L}(D))$, this corresponds to the point $[\sum_{k=0}^n A_k e_k] \in \mathbb{P}(D)$. From the above prp, this point is sent to the divisor $D + \text{div}(\sum_{k=0}^n A_k e_k)$. The coefficient of any point $p \in C$ in the divisor is given by $n_p + \text{val}_p(\sum_{k=0}^n A_k e_k)$. Choosing a uniformizer $\pi \in \mathcal{O}_{C,p}$, the coefficient becomes $(\sum_{k=0}^n A_k e_k) \pi^{n_p}$.

We want to show that the coefficient of p above is the same as the coefficient for p in $(F_D)^*(H)$. Firstly, notice that a generator for the ideal $\mathbb{I}^H(H)\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{L}(D)^*),\phi(p)}$ is given by $\mathbb{I}^H(\mathbb{V}^H(A_0x_0 + \dots + A_nx_n)) = (A_0x_0 + \dots + A_nx_n)$. The coefficient of p in this divisor is by definition, given by $\text{val}_p((F_D)^*(\sum_{k=0}^n A_k x_k))$ where F_D^* here is the map $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{L}(D)^*),\phi(p)} \subseteq k(x_0, \dots, x_n) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{C,p}$. The map sends $\sum_{k=0}^n A_k x_k$ to $(\sum_{k=0}^n A_k x_k) \circ F_D = \sum_{k=0}^n A_k (x_k \circ F_D)$. Now since x_k are the coordinate functions, $x_k \circ F_D$ picks out the effect of F_D on the k th basis vector e_k of $\mathcal{L}(D)$. For each point p , $F_D(p)$ sends $f \in \mathcal{L}(D)$ to $(f\pi^{n_p})(p)$ hence $x_k \circ F_D = e_k \pi^{n_p}$. Thus the coefficient of p of the divisor $(F_D)^*(H)$ coincides with that of the above paragraph. ■

3.2 Classification of Regular Maps into Projective Space

Theorem 3.2.1

Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Let $F : C \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^n$ be a non-constant regular map. Let $H \subseteq \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^n$ be a hyperplane such that $D = \phi^*(H)$ is a divisor. Then F is equal to the composition of F_D together with a sequence of projections $\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^k \setminus \mathbb{V}(p) \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^{k-1}$ for $p \in \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^k$ and a linear embedding $\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^k \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^n$.

Theorem 3.2.2

Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Then C admits an embedding $C \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^3$.

4 Curves with Low Genus

4.1 Genus 0 Curves

We show that $\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1$ is the unique (up to isomorphism) smooth irreducible projective curve with genus 0. We also exhibit characterizing properties of $\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1$ in terms of divisors.

Proposition 4.1.1

Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve over $\mathbb{C}$. Then the following are equivalent.

- C is isomorphic to $\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1$.
- The geometric genus $p_g(C) = 0$ is zero.
- For all $p, q \in C$, $p \sim q$ are linearly equivalent.
- There exists distinct $p, q \in C$, such that $p \sim q$ are linearly equivalent.
- The degree map $\deg : \text{Pic}(C) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ is an isomorphism.
- For all $D \in \text{Div}(C)$ with $\deg(D) > 0$, we have $l(D) = \deg(D) + 1$.
- There exists $D \in \text{Div}(C)$ with $\deg(D) > 0$ such that $l(D) = \deg(D) + 1$.

Proof

(1) $\implies$ (2): Consider $d(x/y) \in \Omega_{\mathbb{C}(\mathbb{P}^1)/\mathbb{C}}^1$. On the affine chart U_y , the differential form is given by $d(x)$. For any $p \in U_y$, $x - p$ is a uniformizer for $\mathcal{O}_{U_y, p}$ since m_p is generated by $x - p$ alone. Then $d(x - p) = d(x)$ and so $\text{val}_{[p:1]}(d(x/y)) = 0$ for all $p \in \mathbb{C}$. Now for the remaining point $[0 : 1]$, we consider the open chart U_x . The differential form is now given by $d(1/y)$. Moreover, $m_0\mathcal{O}_{U_x, 0}$ is generated by y and so it is also the uniformizer. Then we have $d(1/y) = -1/y^2 d(y)$ be the chain rule and so $\text{val}_{[0:1]}(d(x/y)) = -2$. Hence $\text{div}(d(x/y)) = -2$. Then we have $p_g(\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1) = \dim(K_{\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1}) = \dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(\text{div}(d(x/y)))) = 0$.

(2) $\implies$ (3): Let $p, q \in C$ be two points. By the Riemann Roch theorem, we have

$$\dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(p - q)) - \dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(K_C - p + q)) = 1$$

Since $\deg(p - q) = 0 \geq -2 = 2p_g(C) - 2$, we have that $\dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(K_C - p + q)) = 0$ and so $\dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(p - q)) = 1$. Then by 2.2.4 we conclude that $p - q$ is a principal divisor.

(3) $\implies$ (4): Clear.

(4) $\implies$ (1): Suppose that $p - q$ is a principal divisor for some $p, q \in C$ distinct. Then there exists $f \in \mathbb{C}(C)$ such that $\text{div}(f) = p - q$. The rational function $f : C \rightarrow \mathbb{A}_{\mathbb{C}}^1$ gives rise to a rational map $\phi : C \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1$ by identifying $\mathbb{A}_{\mathbb{C}}^1$ with the open chart U_y . It is non constant since $f(p) = 0$. Moreover, it is regular at $C \setminus \{p\}$. Then we can extend this rational map into a non-constant regular map $\bar{\phi} : C \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1$. In particular, $\bar{\phi}$ is surjective. Since $\phi(C \setminus \{q\}) \subseteq \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1 \setminus \{[1 : 0]\}$ and $\bar{\phi}$ is surjective, we conclude that $\bar{\phi}(q) = [1 : 0]$. Now we know that $\phi^*([1 : 0]) = e_{\phi}(q)q$ where ϕ^* is the map $\text{Div}(\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1) \rightarrow \text{Div}(C)$. Hence $e_{\phi}(q) = 1$. Then we have $\deg(\bar{\phi}) = e_{\phi}(q) = 1$ by 2.1.2. Hence $k(C)$ is one dimensional over $k(\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1)$ and so C and $\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1$ are birational. Hence C and $\mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^1$ are isomorphic.

(3) $\iff$ (5): If $p \sim q$ for any two points $p, q \in C$, then any degree 0 divisor is principal and so the surjective homomorphism $\deg : \text{Pic}(C) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ is an isomorphism by the first isomorphism theorem. Conversely, if $\deg : \text{Pic}(C) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ is an isomorphism, then $[p - q] \in \ker(\deg)$ for any $p, q \in C$ implies that $p - q$ is principal.

(2) $\implies$ (6): Let $D \in \text{Div}(C)$ be a divisor such that $\deg(D) \geq 0$. Then we have $\deg(D) \geq 0 \geq -2 = 2p_g(C) - 2$ and so $\dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(D)) = \deg(D) + 1$ by a corollary of the Riemann Roch theorem.

(6) $\implies$ (7): Clear.

(7) $\implies$ (4): Let D be a divisor as in the assumption. Let $p_1, \dots, p_n \in C$ be points. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned} \deg(D) + 1 &= \dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(D)) \\ &\leq \dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(D - p_1)) + 1 \\ &\leq \dots \\ &\leq \dim_{\mathbb{C}}\left(\mathcal{L}\left(D - \sum_{k=1}^{n-1} p_k\right)\right) + (n-1) \\ &\leq \dim_{\mathbb{C}}\left(\mathcal{L}\left(D - \sum_{k=1}^n p_k\right)\right) + n \end{aligned}$$

by lemma 2.2.5. When $n = \deg(D) + 1$, we have that $\dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(D - \sum_{k=1}^n p_k)) = 0$ by 2.2.4. So all the inequalities are equal. In particular, we have

$$\dim_{\mathbb{C}}\left(\mathcal{L}\left(D - \sum_{k=1}^{\deg(D)-1} p_k\right)\right) + (\deg(D) - 1) = \deg(D) + 1$$

and so $\dim_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathcal{L}(D - \sum_{k=1}^{\deg(D)-1} p_k)) = 2$. Let $f_1, f_2 \in \mathcal{L}(D - \sum_{k=1}^{\deg(D)-1} p_k)$ be linearly independent. Since $D - \sum_{k=1}^{\deg(D)-1} p_k$ has degree 1 and $D - \sum_{k=1}^{\deg(D)-1} p_k + \text{div}(f_1)$ and $D - \sum_{k=1}^{\deg(D)-1} p_k + \text{div}(f_2)$ are effective, there exists $p, q \in C$ such that $D - \sum_{k=1}^{\deg(D)-1} p_k = p$ and $D - \sum_{k=1}^{\deg(D)-1} p_k = q$. Also, we have $p - q = \text{div}(f_1/f_2)$ and so $p \sim q$. Finally, p and q are distinct points because otherwise $\text{div}(f_1/f_2) = 0$ implies that f_1 and f_2 are linear multiples of each other, contradicting linear independence. ■

4.2 Genus 1 Curves

Definition 4.2.1

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve over k . We say that C is elliptic if $p_g(C) = 1$.

Proposition 4.2.2

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve over k . Then C is an elliptic curve if and only if CV admits an embedding $C \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_k^2$ of degree 3.

Proposition 4.2.3

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve over k . Then C is an elliptic curve if and only if it is isomorphic to the projective closure of $\mathbb{V}(y^2 - (x^3 + ax + b))$ for some $a, b \in k$ such that $4a^3 + 27b^2 \neq 0$.

Proposition 4.2.4

Let k be an algebraically closed field. Let C be an elliptic curve over k . Then there is a bijection of sets

$$C(k) \cong \text{Pic}^0(C)$$

4.3 Genus 2 Curve

Proposition 4.3.1

Let C be a smooth irreducible projective curve over $\mathbb{C}$ of genus 2. Then C admits an embedding $C \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^3$ as a degree 5 curve.